



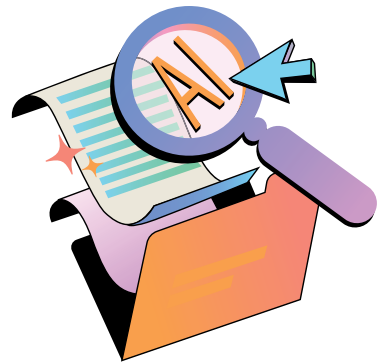
BIG BETS

Two big-ticket deals kicked off this year's Indian Premier League (IPL). Royal Challengers Bengaluru was picked up by a consortium led by the Aditya Birla Group for \$1.78 billion, while US-based entrepreneur Kal Somani cut a cheque for \$1.63 billion to own Rajasthan Royals. It was an affirmation that India is the most dominant force in international cricket. The IPL, which started in 2008, has now evolved to become cricket's most exciting and expensive property. IPL valuation stands at \$8.8 billion as of 2025.

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PRIVACY WOES

Perplexity AI is facing scrutiny over allegations that it shared user data with Meta and Google without explicit consent, raising fresh concerns around AI data governance. The development underscores growing risks tied to how AI platforms collect, process, and potentially distribute user data. As regulatory oversight struggles to keep pace with this fast-moving tech, questions around transparency, consent frameworks, and data security in generative AI ecosystems are becoming increasingly critical. Experts warn of an urgent need for clearer consent protocols in AI-driven applications.



**\$63.6
BN**

INDIA'S EXPECTED PETROLEUM IMPORT BILL IN Q2FY27, 29% YOY RISE, AS TENSIONS IN WEST ASIA PUSH UP CRUDE PRICES, AS PER CMIE ESTIMATES

EXPATS IN THE COCKPIT

India's domestic aviation players' love for foreign CEOs continues. Air India and IndiGo are both on the hunt for expats as they look to further expand their international operations. IndiGo ended up getting on board IATA DG Willie Walsh (in the pic)—an Irish national—after the exit of Pieter Elbers, who hailed from Denmark. Air India is also looking for an expat to replace New Zealander Campbell Wilson as CEO, who has put in his resignation.

